

Can AI Find What Developers Need? Defining and Measuring Knowledge Availability for AI in Developer Ecosystems

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AI agents increasingly mediate developers' access to technical knowledge. Assessing this access requires examining whether relevant sources can be discovered, their content acquired, and the resulting guidance applied to a development task. We define knowledge availability for AI through a task-level protocol with eleven indicators covering knowledge sources, acquisition effort, and response properties. A retrospective application examines 26 accelerator-development tasks: 25 CANN/CUDA pairs and one separate migration analogy. The analysis identifies task-specific acquisition failures, recurring version ambiguities, and variation in support from official materials, third-party sources, and estimated model knowledge. Contrasting cases suggest that dependence on ecosystem-specific knowledge helps interpret differences that task depth alone does not explain. These findings distinguish broad documentation improvements from repairs to localized breakdowns and inform agent interfaces that expose evidence and applicability. We contribute a framework, an inspectable protocol, and a case-based account of how multidimensional assessment informs diagnosis and design.

CCS Concepts: • **Human-centered computing** → **HCI theory, concepts and models**; • **Software and its engineering** → *Documentation*.

Additional Key Words and Phrases: knowledge availability for AI; developer ecosystems; technical documentation; information foraging; AI agents; measurement methods

1 INTRODUCTION

Developers routinely move between documentation, code examples, search results, and community explanations while deciding what to do next. Research on opportunistic programming and developers' information needs shows that finding and interpreting information is part of programming itself [2, 6, 12]. A useful result must fit the current task: a command needs the right options, an API example needs the right version, and an explanation of an error needs enough context to guide investigation. The existence of documentation is therefore only one condition for its usefulness.

Development agents with retrieval and tool-use capabilities introduce another collaborative route through this knowledge environment. A developer may ask about an error or a code fragment, or state a desired change or outcome and delegate information seeking, documentation reading, implementation planning, and portions of code modification to an agent. To advance such a task, the agent may search, read, and combine material across official sites, documentation, repositories, and communities before drafting a response, an implementation approach, or a code change. Studies of code-generation tools, conversational programming assistance, and agent support describe opportunities for this support alongside difficulties in understanding and checking generated suggestions [1, 10, 13]. Delegating information seeking does not remove the need for applicable evidence. It changes who encounters the documentation, through which interface, and what information reaches the developer.

Consider an agent asked how to implement and integrate a custom accelerator operator. A search may return an official development guide, yet the reading tool may obtain only navigation and metadata. For an error-diagnosis task, the same tool may obtain the full official page, but the page may contain only a generic instruction to inspect logs. A retrieval-success measure can mark both questions as having relevant results. An access measure distinguishes the first failure but not the second. Even adequate instructions can remain ambiguous when they refer to incompatible

toolkit and framework versions. These distinctions matter to documentation teams deciding what to repair and to agent designers deciding what uncertainty to expose.

Existing evaluation approaches already distinguish retrieval quality, context relevance, answer faithfulness, and related properties. RAGAS and ARES provide component-level evaluation of retrieval-augmented generation, while ALCE examines generated answers and their citations [3, 4, 11]. Our contribution addresses a complementary measurement problem: how to inspect the technical knowledge conditions encountered by an agent while addressing a concrete development task, including access failures, version relations, alternative sources, and the provenance of an auditor’s judgments. This requires connecting the developer’s information requirement to the resources actually obtained, rather than inferring availability from a fluent answer.

We define **knowledge availability for AI** as the extent to which task-relevant technical knowledge can be discovered, obtained, and assessed for applicability by a specified agent and tool configuration under stated retrieval conditions. The construct is relational: it concerns a task, a knowledge environment, and a means of accessing that environment at a particular time. We operationalize it through an evidence-recording protocol and eleven indicators. The indicators distinguish source conditions, acquisition effort, response checks, and a composite confidence score calculated from M1-M8.

We ask two research questions. **RQ1:** How can knowledge availability for AI be defined and operationalized so that task-specific access conditions and evidence gaps can be systematically recorded and reviewed? **RQ2:** What patterns of knowledge availability does the method reveal across development tasks, and how can those patterns inform documentation and agent design?

We address these questions through a methodological framework and a retrospective application to an existing accelerator-development audit. The archive contains 26 task categories and 52 task-side records. Twenty-five categories compare CANN and CUDA development contexts; one migration category uses ROCm/HIP as the comparison destination and is treated separately. The case application connects task-level measurement to cross-task patterns and design implications. We contribute (1) a construct that distinguishes knowledge conditions from retrieval success and answer correctness; (2) a task-level protocol, indicator definitions, and portable analysis materials; and (3) worked cases and a cross-task synthesis that distinguish different breakdowns and connect them to documentation and agent design.

2 RELATED WORK AND CONSTRUCT BOUNDARIES

2.1 Developer information seeking and documentation

Information foraging theory relates information-seeking behavior to the structure and expected value of available information [8]. Programming studies show how developers interleave searching, learning, and implementation, and how their questions depend on the work they are performing [2, 6, 12]. API-learning difficulties further motivate attention to the explanatory resources surrounding a technical interface [9]. These studies motivate our task-level unit and the distinction between encountering a resource and obtaining what a task requires.

Our method does not infer human usability from machine access. A page readable by a browser can be inaccessible to a particular extraction tool; conversely, text readily extracted by an agent can still be difficult for a person to navigate. We examine the conditions of the delegated knowledge route. Claims about developers’ time, trust, satisfaction, or task completion require separate evidence.

2.2 AI support for programming

Research on code-generation and conversational tools examines how developers use and evaluate AI assistance [1, 10, 13]. This work provides the interaction context for our study: technical suggestions enter development activities where their applicability must be assessed. We focus on the availability of supporting knowledge before drawing conclusions about how people use those suggestions.

Agents can interleave reasoning and tool use, and retrieval-augmented generation provides a way to incorporate external information into generation [7, 15]. WebArena, SWE-bench, and SWE-agent evaluate or develop agents in realistic web and software-engineering settings [5, 14, 16]. Their task outcomes are valuable evidence of system performance. Our framework offers a complementary description of the knowledge conditions under which such systems operate. A failure can involve unavailable evidence, inadequate interpretation of available evidence, or unsuccessful execution; the present method directly addresses the first of these and records information relevant to separating them.

2.3 Retrieval, attribution, and the availability construct

RAGAS and ARES assess properties of retrieved context and generated answers; ALCE evaluates citation-supported generation [3, 4, 11]. Accordingly, we do not claim that previous evaluation treats retrieval or answer quality as indivisible. Our methodological focus is the connection between technical-task requirements, the acquisition process, and the structure of the surrounding knowledge ecosystem. Version compatibility, partial access to a how-to guide, and dependence on a community workaround are particularly consequential in this setting.

The distinctions in Table 1 position the construct. Availability can be necessary for an evidence-grounded answer without being sufficient for correctness. An agent can misinterpret an available source. It can also produce a correct answer from prior knowledge without obtaining any external evidence. These outcomes should remain distinguishable.

Table 1. Construct boundaries and neighboring objects of assessment.

Object of assessment	Central question	Relationship to this method
Retrieval success	Was a relevant result returned?	One acquisition condition; not proof that required content was obtained.
Documentation usability	Can intended readers navigate and understand the material?	A related human-facing property requiring its own evaluation.
Knowledge availability for AI	What task-relevant knowledge was obtainable under the recorded conditions?	The construct operationalized here.
Answer correctness and attribution	Is the response correct, and do its sources support its claims?	A downstream evaluation that may use the acquired evidence.
Execution success	Do the proposed actions work in the target environment?	Requires execution or other independent outcome evidence.

3 METHODOLOGICAL FRAMEWORK

3.1 Unit of analysis and task requirements

The unit is a **task-side acquisition episode**: a development objective pursued in a particular technical ecosystem using a stated agent and retrieval configuration. A task specification records the desired outcome, starting artifacts, constraints, version dependencies, and evidence required to support a next action. For example, model conversion may require a conversion command, an input-shape specification, a target-device setting, and a way to check the generated artifact. These requirements guide inspection; a long page is not automatically adequate.

Task selection must follow the purpose of the application. An ecosystem assessment may seek coverage across workflows; a documentation-team audit may focus on recurring support questions. Neither establishes the population frequency of those tasks without additional sampling evidence. For cross-ecosystem use, analysts record differences in starting conditions and task scope rather than assuming that similar names make tasks equivalent. The framework can also be applied within one ecosystem, across versions, or across retrieval configurations, provided the comparison conditions are made explicit.

Figure 1 locates the measurements in an observable tool-use loop. It is an analytic model, not a reconstruction of hidden model reasoning: the agent searches for candidate sources, selects URLs, fetches content or records a failure, then integrates evidence and assesses task adequacy and version applicability. When evidence is insufficient but remains searchable, the loop returns to query refinement. Model prior is registered as a separate branch that need not produce an observable source; it is therefore not automatically treated as traceable evidence.

3.2 Sources, acquisition, and action conditions

The framework retains three channels from the original audit: official materials, community or third-party materials, and model prior knowledge. For external channels, it separates **access** from **adequacy**. Discovery concerns whether a candidate source is found; acquisition concerns what the reading tool actually returns. Adequacy concerns whether that return supplies the task-required commands, explanations, parameters, or diagnostic cases. Version applicability is examined across channels because sources can be individually informative while describing different environments.

Official status is determined by the publisher’s relationship to the material, not by its hosting platform. A vendor’s repository or blog belongs to that vendor’s official channel. An independently authored tutorial hosted on the same platform can have a different status. Cross-posting also makes domain diversity an imperfect proxy for independent evidence. The protocol therefore preserves source identity, publisher, date when available, and any observed derivation or duplication. Lack of these details is recorded as uncertainty.

The output of the method is an **availability profile** with an evidence trail. It identifies what was found, what was obtained, what appears adequate, what applicability conditions remain unresolved, and what acquisition effort was recorded. An optional aggregate can help summarize a chosen operationalization, but it cannot replace this profile. In particular, internal model knowledge cannot make an inaccessible external source accessible, even if it enables an answer.

3.3 An evidence record

The evidence record connects each judgment to its basis. Its minimum fields are the task question and starting conditions; agent and tool configuration when known; collection time; queries and selected URLs; publisher and source role; returned content or a retained excerpt; access outcome; applicable versions; task requirements supported by that

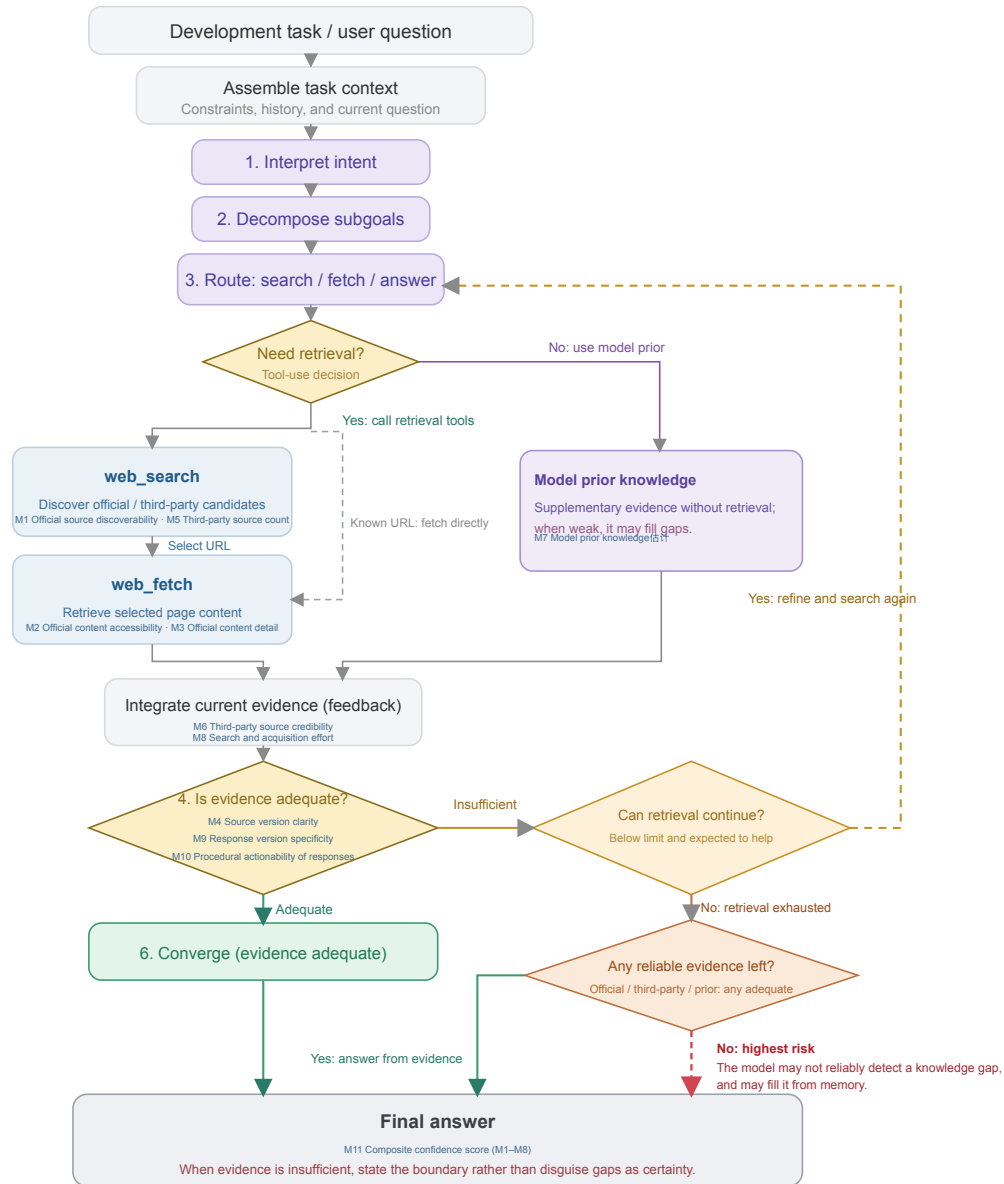


Fig. 1. An agent starts from a task and context, interprets intent, decomposes subgoals, and routes to retrieval or model prior; a retrieval branch searches, selects URLs, fetches content or fetches a known URL directly, then integrates evidence and assesses adequacy. Insufficient evidence can trigger retry; exhausted retrieval distinguishes whether reliable evidence remains.

content; acquisition counts; and the coding decision with a rationale. A field also identifies whether an entry is directly recorded, subsequently coded, estimated, or unavailable.

This distinction prevents a common reporting error: transforming an interpretation into an observation merely because a script assigns it a number. A logged extraction failure is an observation of the tool-source interaction. Labeling an explanation as sufficient is a judgment against task requirements. Estimating a model’s familiarity with a toolkit is an inference unless a separate test supports it. Numerical coding does not erase these differences.

4 OPERATIONALIZATION AND MEASUREMENT PROTOCOL

4.1 Eleven indicators and their evidential roles

Table 2 specifies the indicators retained from the audit and clarifies their evidential roles. The numbering preserves the connection to the archived data. The proposed operationalization uses content outcomes for access, distinguishes inferred prior knowledge from acquired sources, and interprets output checks as properties of recorded instructions rather than successful execution.

Table 2. The eleven indicators and the evidence each can support.

ID	Indicator	Evidence and interpretation
M1	Official source discoverability	Recorded query rounds and official-result position; identifies discovery effort under the selected search conditions.
M2	Official content accessibility	Whether official core content was obtained, partially obtained, not obtained, or unknown; concerns returned content, not the site’s implementation technology. Access route is recorded separately as original entry, alternative entry, or unknown.
M3	Official content detail	The level of task-required commands, parameters, explanations, and reference detail in acquired official content; it records content detail and does not by itself establish that a task is adequately resolved; unobserved when the content was not obtained.
M4	Source version clarity	Explicit scope, compatibility relations, and unresolved version branches in source materials; several maintained versions do not by themselves imply ambiguity.
M5	Third-party source count	The number of recorded third-party sources beyond the official channel; it is not a coverage rate with task requirements as its denominator.
M6	Third-party source credibility	Authorship, currency, consistency, and evidence of derivation for third-party sources; domain diversity alone establishes neither independence nor the correctness of every item.
M7	Estimated model prior knowledge	Explicitly identified estimate or separate no-retrieval measurement; the archive contains estimates, not measured training coverage.
M8	Search and acquisition effort	Raw search, read, retry, and refinement counts; a cost model is disclosed separately from those counts and does not represent actual time, tokens, or monetary cost. The historical matrix displays an inverse effort score, while the worked record retains the underlying calls alongside its code.

ID	Indicator	Evidence and interpretation
M9	Response version specificity	Whether the recorded response or guidance identifies an exact combination, a constrained range, or unresolved dependencies; it does not mean the combination was execution-verified.
M10	Procedural actionability of responses	Whether the recorded response or guidance can be followed directly, with parameter substitution, or after minor adaptation; not proof that code was executed.
M11	Composite confidence score	Historical aggregate computed from M1-M8; M9-M10 are reported separately. It reflects disclosed aggregation assumptions, not a calibrated probability of correctness or task success.

M1-M6 describe source conditions; M7 registers a different basis for possible answer formation; M8 describes search and acquisition effort; M9-M10 check response version specificity and procedural actionability; M11 aggregates the historical M1-M8 codes. These components can covary, but they are not interchangeable. They also need not apply to every task: a concept-explanation task may have no meaningful version-pinning requirement. Such cases require an explicit not-applicable state rather than a fabricated successful observation.

4.2 Applying the protocol

First, define the task and the recording boundary. State the development outcome, starting artifacts, and requirements against which adequacy will be assessed. Record the agent, tools, language, date, and context policy. Specify whether the unit includes a fresh acquisition, reused observations, or both. Set a retrieval budget or another observable stopping criterion appropriate to the application; an analyst must not infer an agent’s internal reasons for stopping from the number of queries alone.

Second, record discovery and acquisition. Preserve queries, candidate sources, selected URLs, and read outcomes. Inspect official materials and record the community alternatives actually encountered, whether from mixed search results or subsequent searches. Keep a failed read separate from a failed search. When a mirror or another version supplies the required content, link it to the original attempt so that the workaround remains visible.

Third, assess task support and applicability. Map acquired material to the task requirements. Distinguish a returned document with missing essential content from a document that was never returned. Record stated versions and compatibility dependencies, including unresolved local facts. A version number in a URL is a clue, not by itself a verified compatibility relation.

Fourth, code with provenance. Apply published anchors, retain the observation-to-code mapping, and mark estimates and missing fields. Content acquisition status has four states: core content obtained; partial content obtained; required content not obtained; and unknown. Record access route separately as original entry, alternative entry, or unknown. Thus a complete mirrored body remains core content obtained even when it arrived through an alternative entry. Adequacy can use ordered anchors ranging from a generic fragment, through an overview and a usable main path, to detailed task-relevant reference material. The coding rationale identifies the specific requirements covered; it should not rely only on page length.

Fifth, inspect the instructions and report the profile. Where the final response is retained, map its material steps and version claims to acquired evidence. Where only notes about possible instructions remain, identify M9-M10

as judgments about those notes. Report contradictions, source dependencies, and unsupported steps. If an aggregate is included, report its formula, missing-data treatment, and dependence on assumptions. The accompanying worked recording example makes the chain from requirement to event, source, saved evidence, and code explicit, including raw calls alongside the M8 effort code. This final distinction is essential for retrospective use of incomplete archives.

The method’s novelty lies in this connected specification of the unit, evidence record, indicator roles, and diagnostic interpretation. Search rank, reading success, and version labels are familiar observations. Their value here comes from relating them to the requirements of one development task and preserving how an observation becomes a diagnosis.

4.3 Ordinal anchors and the historical aggregate

The archived implementation maps most fields to five ordered levels. For example, official discoverability combines the approximate position of the first official result with whether another search was needed; official content detail distinguishes fragments, overviews, main-path material, and extensive reference material. Source version clarity uses the observed number of versions and presence of a compatibility matrix. These are operational choices, not natural measurement intervals. The version rule in particular is a proxy: a larger version count can reflect good archival coverage as well as unresolved applicability.

The archive also defines a composite confidence score. For historical scores s_i , it uses $n(s_i) = s_i/5$, with unavailable official content detail contributing zero to the official branch:

$$O = n(s_1)n(s_2)n(s_3), \quad C = n(s_5)n(s_6), \quad P = n(s_7).$$

$$I = [1 - (1 - O)(1 - C)(1 - P)] [0.7 + 0.3n(s_4)] [0.9 + 0.1n(s_8)].$$

The noisy-OR-shaped expression represents a design intuition: different channels may compensate for one another. Its factors are ordinal transformations, however, not calibrated probabilities, and source independence is not established. We therefore retain I as a **composite confidence score**: it aggregates the historical M1-M8 codes, while M9-M10 are reported separately as response-level checks. Unknown content quality remains unknown even when its unavailable branch contributes zero to a historical calculation.

The archive’s M2 rule awards static pages a higher value than server-rendered pages. We retain that rule only to reproduce the archived index; the protocol above evaluates returned content regardless of rendering technology. This separation preserves the historical record without prescribing an unjustified implementation-based penalty. The index is presented as one auditable aggregation choice, while the profile and worked evidence chains carry the methodological argument.

5 CASE APPLICATION: ACCELERATOR DEVELOPMENT ECOSYSTEMS

5.1 Task coverage and comparison scope

The application draws on a development-task audit recorded on June 10-11, 2026. It covers environment setup, operator development, training, inference and deployment, performance analysis, debugging, and migration. Examples include model conversion, custom-operator integration, distributed initialization, version compatibility, and memory-error investigation. The task set sought workflow coverage; it was not sampled to estimate how often developers encounter these needs. Developer-role groupings organize task scenarios around the typical knowledge needs of different roles.

CANN and CUDA provide a useful setting because the tasks involve specialized APIs, toolchains, framework integration, and version dependencies. The task wording uses each ecosystem’s terminology. This yields contextual comparisons, not controlled substitutions of equivalent APIs. In task A, for example, the CUDA question begins with a PyTorch model and asks for a TensorRT deployment path, whereas the CANN question starts with an ONNX model and asks for an ATC conversion. These scope differences must remain visible when interpreting effort and completeness.

Task G is a distinct migration analogy. Its comparison question concerns moving CUDA code to AMD ROCm/HIP and its official material comes from AMD. It remains in the 26-task archive as a worked migration case, but is excluded from CANN/CUDA aggregate comparisons, leaving 25 pairs and 50 task-side records for those summaries. Its separate treatment demonstrates why source and comparison identity belong in the measurement protocol.

5.2 Records and the development of the method

The evidence consists of the process log, structured observation fields and scoring functions, an interactive task matrix, indicator definitions, and analytic visualizations. The process log retains questions, query strings, source descriptions, read outcomes, and coding explanations at different levels of detail. The initial tasks include longer stepwise accounts; later tasks often contain more compact summaries. Some early read assessments refer to observations already available in the original session. The records document an evolving audit, including observations reused across sessions.

The first two batches covered A-D and E-H. Later batches covered I-S and T-Z through parallel subagents whose structured observations were consolidated in the main session. The log describes source reclassification during that consolidation. It also states that the later question wording was recovered from the original task-assignment transcript. Those questions are retained with their reported provenance. The full transcript referenced by the log is not included in the materials analyzed here.

The recorded system is identified as Claude using web search and a web-reading tool that summarized HTML. The archive does not establish the exact deployed model identifier, extraction-model version, search-provider configuration, or a uniform stopping budget across episodes. Complete returns and final responses are not consistently retained; M9-M10 therefore preserve archival assessments of the available guidance. The supplementary provenance notes identify the retained fields and unavailable configuration details.

The framework developed iteratively through the audit. A consequential revision was the rejection of a site-wide access assumption when a main-path quickstart returned useful content. This paper consolidates the protocol and separates observations from estimates and aggregation choices. The supplementary protocol and worked record make the resulting recording structure explicit.

5.3 Recorded profiles

Among the 25 CANN task-side records in the main comparison, 22 are coded as core content obtained, two as partial content obtained, and one as core content not obtained. The corresponding CUDA records are all coded as core content obtained. The frozen archive does not consistently retain whether an entry was original or alternative, so route is not inferred retrospectively. Figures 2–4 present all eleven archival indicators and group tasks by environment and installation, operator development, training, inference and deployment, performance and optimization, debugging, and migration. G remains a separately marked CANN/ROCm-HIP migration analogy and is excluded from CANN/CUDA summaries.

In Figures 2–4, M1–M10 are frozen archival ordinal codes from 1 to 5, while M11 is the historical composite confidence score computed from M1–M8. M2 is a historical official-content-accessibility score rather than the actual state

A. Official-source conditions

Archived codes by workflow. Each task row has CANN and CUDA columns; G uses ROCm/HIP in the second column.

Task	M1 Official find		M2 Official access		M3 Official detail		M4 Source version	
	CANN	CUDA†	CANN	CUDA‡	CANN	CUDA‡	CANN	CUDA‡
Environment and installation								
I Version compatibility	3	3	4	5	4	5	4	4
J Installation	5	4	4	5	5	5	2	3
K Container setup	5	5	5	5	5	4	4	5
Operator development								
C Library selection	4	5	4	5	3	5	3	5
D Custom operator	2	5	2	5	—	5	2	3
L Operator accuracy	2	2	4	5	5	5	2	5
M Dynamic shapes / tiling	2	5	4	5	4	5	4	4
N Operator fusion	5	2	4	5	5	4	2	5
O Framework integration	2	5	4	5	5	5	3	3
Training								
F Distributed training	4	5	4	5	4	5	2	3
P Mixed precision	3	5	4	5	4	5	4	5
Q Memory / OOM	5	5	4	5	5	5	4	5
R Training convergence	3	3	4	5	5	4	3	5
Inference and deployment								
A Model conversion	4	5	4	5	4	5	2	4
H Quantization	3	5	4	5	3	5	2	3
S Inference serving	5	5	4	5	4	5	3	4
T Dynamic inference	3	3	4	5	5	5	2	5
Performance and optimization								
B Profiling	4	4	4	5	4	5	2	4
U Memory / occupancy	4	5	4	5	4	5	5	5
V Compute-transfer overlap	4	5	4	5	4	5	2	5
W Multi-device communication	2	5	4	5	3	4	3	4
Debugging								
E Error-code diagnosis	3	4	4	5	2	5	2	5
X Memory-error diagnosis	5	5	4	5	5	5	2	3
Migration								
Y Chip migration	2	5	4	5	4	5	3	4
Z Programming concepts	5	5	4	5	5	4	5	5
Migration analogy (not in CANN/CUDA summaries)								
G Migration analogy	4	5	4	5	4	5	4	3

M1–M10 are archived ordinal codes (1–5; higher is more favorable; M8 is an inverse effort score). “—” = unobserved official content detail.

* M7 is an archived estimate. † M11 is the historical composite confidence score from M1–M8. ‡ For G, CUDA‡ = ROCm/HIP; it is excluded from CANN/CUDA summaries.

Fig. 2. Full indicator matrix (1/3): archival M1–M4 codes for official discoverability, official content accessibility, official content detail, and source version clarity, organized by workflow with CANN and CUDA columns for each task. G uses ROCm/HIP in the second column.

of content acquisition. To make D and similar cases interpretable, Figure 5 retains the acquisition state separately so that “content not obtained” is not collapsed into a score.

For the 25 task pairs, the historical composite confidence means are .732 for CANN and .922 for CUDA. These summaries use the archived codes; their task-level variation is examined alongside the individual indicators in the findings below. The supplementary analysis notes document source-ownership corrections, unresolved counting boundaries, and sensitivity to the model-prior term.

6 FINDINGS: KNOWLEDGE CONDITIONS ACROSS DEVELOPMENT TASKS

Reading the matrix across tasks and across indicators reveals four connected patterns. Access failures are concentrated in particular acquisition routes, while version ambiguity recurs across otherwise different tasks. Official, third-party,

B. Third-party, prior, and acquisition conditions

Archived codes by workflow. Each task row has CANN and CUDA columns; G uses ROCm/HIP in the second column.

Task	M5 3P count		M6 3P credibility		M7 Prior estimate*		M8 Search / access effort	
	CANN	CUDA†	CANN	CUDA‡	CANN	CUDA‡	CANN	CUDA‡
Environment and installation								
I Version compatibility	3	2	4	4	2	4	3	3
J Installation	3	3	4	4	4	5	5	5
K Container setup	2	3	2	4	3	5	1	4
Operator development								
C Library selection	3	5	4	4	3	5	5	5
D Custom operator	3	4	2	4	2	5	1	5
L Operator accuracy	3	2	4	4	3	4	4	1
M Dynamic shapes / tiling	2	2	4	4	2	5	3	5
N Operator fusion	2	2	3	4	2	4	5	1
O Framework integration	3	2	5	4	3	5	1	3
Training								
F Distributed training	3	3	3	4	3	4	5	5
P Mixed precision	3	3	4	4	4	5	2	4
Q Memory / OOM	3	3	4	4	3	5	3	2
R Training convergence	3	3	4	3	3	5	3	4
Inference and deployment								
A Model conversion	4	4	4	4	3	4	4	5
H Quantization	4	3	3	4	3	4	4	5
S Inference serving	2	3	4	4	2	4	4	5
T Dynamic inference	3	2	5	4	3	5	3	1
Performance and optimization								
B Profiling	3	4	3	4	3	4	4	5
U Memory / occupancy	3	3	4	4	3	5	4	5
V Compute-transfer overlap	3	3	4	4	3	5	4	4
W Multi-device communication	3	3	4	4	3	4	3	5
Debugging								
E Error-code diagnosis	3	4	3	4	2	4	4	5
X Memory-error diagnosis	2	3	4	4	2	4	4	5
Migration								
Y Chip migration	3	3	4	4	3	5	1	4
Z Programming concepts	3	3	4	4	4	5	1	1
Migration analogy (not in CANN/CUDA summaries)								
G Migration analogy	3	3	4	4	3	4	5	5

M1–M10 are archived ordinal codes (1–5; higher is more favorable; M8 is an inverse effort score). "—" = unobserved official content detail.

* M7 is an archived estimate. † M11 is the historical composite confidence score from M1–M8. ‡ For G, CUDA‡ = ROCm/HIP; it is excluded from CANN/CUDA summaries.

Fig. 3. Full indicator matrix (2/3): archival M5–M8 codes for third-party source count, third-party source credibility, estimated model prior knowledge, and search and acquisition effort, in the same workflow and task order.

and model-prior assessments form different support profiles, and workflow position alone does not explain those profiles. We develop each finding through the task records and use the combination of indicators to locate its implications.

6.1 Acquisition breakdowns vary by task and access path

The CANN records contain useful official content across installation, conversion, training, and optimization tasks, alongside a small number of incomplete or unsuccessful acquisitions. This distribution supports inspection at the level of a task and its selected resources. A single site label, such as static or dynamically rendered, cannot describe the content obtained along every route through that site. The 25 CUDA records all contain acquired core official content, providing a contrast for the routes documented in this case application. The discovery records also differ: 13 of 25 CANN tasks and 20 of 25 CUDA tasks were recorded with one search round; the remainder had two. These counts distinguish search effort from whether the selected content was subsequently obtained.

C. Response checks and composite confidence

Archived codes by workflow. Each task row has CANN and CUDA columns; G uses ROCm/HIP in the second column.

Task	M9 Response version		M10 Actionability		M11 Confidence†	
	CANN	CUDA‡	CANN	CUDA‡	CANN	CUDA‡
Environment and installation						
I Version compatibility	5	5	5	5	0.73	0.85
J Installation	4	4	5	5	0.80	0.88
K Container setup	4	4	5	5	0.86	0.98
Operator development						
C Library selection	4	5	4	5	0.77	1.00
D Custom operator	2	5	3	5	0.41	0.88
L Operator accuracy	3	4	4	4	0.69	0.84
M Dynamic shapes / tiling	4	4	4	5	0.63	0.94
N Operator fusion	4	4	4	4	0.74	0.83
O Framework integration	4	4	5	5	0.72	0.84
Training						
F Distributed training	3	4	3	5	0.72	0.88
P Mixed precision	4	5	4	5	0.83	0.98
Q Memory / OOM	3	4	4	5	0.86	0.94
R Training convergence	3	4	4	4	0.75	0.98
Inference and deployment						
A Model conversion	3	5	4	5	0.75	0.94
H Quantization	4	4	5	5	0.69	0.88
S Inference serving	4	4	4	5	0.74	0.94
T Dynamic inference	4	5	4	5	0.72	0.92
Performance and optimization						
B Profiling	3	4	3	5	0.70	0.93
U Memory / occupancy	4	4	4	4	0.88	1.00
V Compute-transfer overlap	4	5	4	5	0.72	0.98
W Multi-device communication	4	5	4	5	0.70	0.92
Debugging						
E Error-code diagnosis	3	4	3	5	0.55	0.99
X Memory-error diagnosis	4	4	5	5	0.74	0.88
Migration						
Y Chip migration	4	5	4	5	0.68	0.92
Z Programming concepts	2	2	2	2	0.90	0.92
Migration analogy (not in CANN/CUDA summaries)						
G Migration analogy	4	4	4	5	0.84	0.88

M1–M10 are archived ordinal codes (1–5; higher is more favorable; M8 is an inverse effort score). “—” = unobserved official content detail.

* M7 is an archived estimate. † M11 is the historical composite confidence score from M1–M8. ‡ For G, CUDA‡ = ROCm/HIP; it is excluded from CANN/CUDA summaries.

Fig. 4. Full indicator matrix (3/3): archival M9–M11 values for response version specificity, procedural actionability of responses, and the historical composite confidence score from M1–M8, in the same workflow and task order.

Task D, creating an Ascend C operator and integrating it with a framework, is the clearest acquisition breakdown. Search results contained community examples and related framework documentation, but the selected official how-to return lacked the required body. M1 registers the discovery conditions and M2 the acquisition outcome; M3 remains unobserved for that missing body. The resulting repair target is the task’s core implementation guide and its entry path. The profile identifies a specific resource to make accessible without treating every page in the ecosystem as equally affected.

Task E exposes a different problem. The official EZ9999 page was found and read, but its explanation supplied an unspecified cause and generic instructions to check the installation or inspect logs. Its low content-detail code reflects the lack of concrete diagnostic guidance in the returned material. The developer’s question requires information about possible triggers and a sequence for narrowing the cause. Improving extraction would leave this content problem in

Access-profile detail

Actual acquisition states are distinct from the historical M2 accessibility scores in Figures 2–4.

Task	Content access		Official content detail		Source version clarity	
	CANN	CUDA‡	CANN	CUDA‡	CANN	CUDA‡
Environment and installation						
I Version compatibility	C	C	4	5	4	4
J Installation	C	C	5	5	2	3
K Container setup	C	C	5	4	4	5
Operator development						
C Library selection	P	C	3	5	3	5
D Custom operator	N	C	—	5	2	3
L Operator accuracy	C	C	5	5	2	5
M Dynamic shapes / tiling	C	C	4	5	4	4
N Operator fusion	C	C	5	4	2	5
O Framework integration	C	C	5	5	3	3
Training						
F Distributed training	C	C	4	5	2	3
P Mixed precision	C	C	4	5	4	5
Q Memory / OOM	C	C	5	5	4	5
R Training convergence	C	C	5	4	3	5
Inference and deployment						
A Model conversion	C	C	4	5	2	4
H Quantization	C	C	3	5	2	3
S Inference serving	C	C	4	5	3	4
T Dynamic inference	C	C	5	5	2	5
Performance and optimization						
B Profiling	C	C	4	5	2	4
U Memory / occupancy	C	C	4	5	5	5
V Compute-transfer overlap	C	C	4	5	2	5
W Multi-device communication	C	C	3	4	3	4
Debugging						
E Error-code diagnosis	C	C	2	5	2	5
X Memory-error diagnosis	C	C	5	5	2	3
Migration						
Y Chip migration	P	C	4	5	3	4
Z Programming concepts	C	C	5	4	5	5
Migration analogy (not in CANN/CUDA summaries)						
G Migration analogy [CANN / ROCm-HIP]	C	C	4	5	4	3

Content status: C = core obtained; P = partial content obtained; N = not obtained. Access route is recorded separately in the protocol.

‡ For G, CUDA‡ = ROCm/HIP; it is a migration analogy and is excluded from CANN/CUDA summaries.

Fig. 5. Access-profile detail that places actual content-acquisition states beside the archival official-content-detail and source-version-clarity codes. It follows the same workflow groups and task order as Figures 2–4, but is retained only to explain access cases.

place. Together, D and E connect similar concerns about obtaining useful guidance to distinct interventions: delivery of the missing how-to body and enrichment of an accessible error explanation.

Task A shows how useful main-path material and unavailable references can coexist. The acquired conversion quickstart supplied an ATC command, input-shape and target-device parameters, and a device-information step. A more extensive ATC/AIPP reference returned navigation and metadata. The worked recording example links the quickstart to supported conversion requirements and the missing reference to unresolved advanced settings. Task Y likewise records a partial acquisition involving a document-center route for chip-migration information. These cases motivate recording both the content obtained and its relation to a task requirement, with the access route recorded separately where available.

6.2 Version applicability is a recurring cross-task issue

Version clarity is a recurrent limitation even where the official content is accessible. Twelve of the 25 CANN task records have $M4 = 2$, spanning conversion, installation, training, operator development, inference, optimization, and debugging. Only U and Z receive $M4 = 5$, and both are coded as version-insensitive. The CUDA records range from 3 to 5. Because the historical rule uses version counts and compatibility-matrix availability, the observed distribution directs attention to the underlying version evidence rather than establishing ambiguity from version counts alone.

The records show why that evidence matters. In A, similar quickstart material appears in more than one version tree. In I, answering a compatibility question requires connecting toolkit, driver, framework, and integration-package information across documentation, repositories, and package records. A page may be detailed and readable while still leaving the reader to determine which combination its instructions support. Version information therefore needs to accompany the content and connect to the environment of the task.

$M4$ and $M9$ make two stages of this problem visible. $M4$ describes version clarity in the source environment; $M9$ records how specifically the resulting guidance identifies an applicable version or combination. Reading them together helps locate whether the next improvement belongs in the documentation’s compatibility information or in how the agent formulates the response. This recurring issue has a wider task footprint than the missing official body in D, although the local acquisition failure remains consequential for that task.

6.3 Knowledge-support profiles differ across tasks

An accessible official guide can coexist with limited alternative material. In X, memory-error investigation, the acquired sanitizer documentation receives $M3 = 5$, while the archive records one third-party source and $M7 = 2$. D also has a low model-prior estimate and weak third-party credibility, but lacks the core official body. The distinction is the available support configuration: X has detailed official guidance, whereas D combines a missing core guide with limited support in the other channels. A single label such as a thin community would obscure this difference.

Across the main comparison, recorded third-party candidates average 3.16 per CANN task and 3.44 per CUDA task after the known vendor-blog exclusion in H. Counts alone provide a modest contrast and do not establish informational independence. The process notes add relevant variation: repeated platforms occur in some records, and blocked third-party pages reduce what can be read beyond a search snippet. The method preserves source identity, acquisition outcome, and credibility assessment so that multiple entries are not automatically interpreted as multiple usable explanations.

The model-prior column adds a separate estimate of support. The CUDA archival scores are all 4 or 5; CANN estimates are frequently lower, including 2 for D, E, I, M, N, S, and X. In these records, lower prior estimates coexist with needs for ecosystem-specific commands, compatibility relations, or diagnostic examples. They motivate examining where retrieved sources must carry more of the task’s support. The estimates describe the audit’s assessment of available model knowledge; the source observations identify the external material actually obtained.

$M9$ and $M10$ complete the profile by describing the version specificity and actionability of the recorded guidance. For example, X combines detailed official material with a higher procedural-actionability code than D. This association gives an analyst a concrete question to inspect: which steps can be supported by the acquired guide, and which still need information from another source or the local environment? The composite confidence score summarizes $M1$ - $M8$, while these response-level codes remain available for examining the resulting guidance.

6.4 Task depth alone does not explain the observed differences

Workflow grouping helps locate concentrations of lower-scored tasks. Table 3 summarizes the 25-pair comparison. Operator development and debugging have lower CANN means than environment and installation, and debugging has the largest difference between the two columns. The debugging group consists of E and X, whose distinct profiles illustrate why a workflow mean needs to be read alongside its constituent tasks. The table describes the selected task set under the archived scoring rules.

Table 3. Workflow means of the historical composite confidence score for 25 task pairs. Difference = CUDA minus CANN; G is excluded.

Workflow	Tasks	CANN	CUDA	Difference
Environment and installation	3	0.799	0.904	0.106
Operator development	6	0.660	0.891	0.230
Training	4	0.791	0.945	0.154
Inference and deployment	4	0.722	0.920	0.198
Performance and optimization	4	0.752	0.957	0.205
Debugging	2	0.646	0.933	0.287
Migration	2	0.793	0.921	0.128

The broader distribution resembles an onboarding-to-specialization gradient, but contrasting cases qualify that interpretation. Installation and container setup have relatively high CANN composite scores, while custom-operator development and dynamic-shape/tiling tasks score lower. Yet U, a technically demanding memory/occupancy task, scores .881, and Z, programming-concept comparison, scores .901. Both involve principles that can be expressed across architectures and have acquired official material. E is comparatively straightforward as a question but depends on a specific error’s diagnostic content and scores .554. Complexity or workflow position alone therefore misses important differences in knowledge requirements.

Dependence on ecosystem-specific knowledge provides an interpretive lens for these cases. General concepts of memory management can draw on cross-platform explanations; a vendor-specific error, operator interface, or compatibility combination requires information tied to that ecosystem. This lens directs the audit toward the knowledge that must be supplied explicitly for a task, rather than assigning a uniform expectation to all advanced work. It also gives developer-role groupings a practical use: grouping the tasks associated with a role can identify which specific knowledge requirements need attention. The present cases motivate this interpretation; testing its predictive value would require an explicit dependency coding scheme and a broader task sample.

7 DISCUSSION: FROM DIAGNOSIS TO KNOWLEDGE AND AGENT DESIGN

The findings connect the framework to two sites of design: the technical knowledge supplied by documentation and communities, and the agent interface through which a developer encounters that knowledge. The following implications are design proposals derived from the observed profiles. The discussion emphasizes the organization, delivery, and maintenance of knowledge provision, then extends to how agents present support and receive local facts. Figures 6-11 illustrate six selected design opportunities within these implications.

Version and compatibility lookup

Design illustration

1 Specify the task environment

Target device

Framework version

Select device

Select installed version

Find supported combinations

2 Compare combinations and their supporting sources

Result structure shown below; compatibility values are placeholders.

Toolkit	Driver range	Framework	Integration package	Evidence
<version>	<range>	<version>	<version>	Inspect sources
<version>	<range>	<version>	<version>	Inspect sources

Each relation retains its source, applicability scope, and verification date.

If no supported match is documented, identify the unresolved conditions.

Motivation: fragmented version information in A / I; linked indicator: M4.

Fig. 6. Proposed version and compatibility lookup, motivated by fragmented version information in A and I. Query constraints, result fields, and source inspection illustrate the proposed information structure; compatibility values are placeholders.

7.1 Supply-side design: version relations, task guidance, and alternative sources

Recurring version issues suggest treating applicability as a property of a documentation system. A stable recommended-version entry can coexist with a clearly indexed archive, while each page states its applicable versions and verification date. Compatibility relations among drivers, toolkits, frameworks, and integration packages can be published in a queryable form. For a task such as I, this would let a developer or agent request the supported combinations for a stated environment, reducing the need to assemble the relation from several disconnected records.

Figure 6 makes this proposal concrete through a compatibility lookup interface. Device and framework constraints define the query, and each returned combination retains its sources, applicability scope, and verification date. Where no supported match is documented, the interface identifies unresolved conditions. The version problem registered by M4 becomes an inspectable relation, providing a basis for subsequently checking the applicability of a response.

Localized acquisition and content gaps call for task-specific repairs. D motivates a readable route to the core operator-development guide, through server-rendered content, a text export, or another stable entry. E already has a dedicated error page; its improvement requires more informative content within that entry: error semantics, possible triggers, diagnostic steps, links to issue cases, and applicable versions. For a catch-all error, a guide can state what the code alone leaves unresolved and specify which logs or local observations are needed next. Such a page supports diagnosis by organizing available evidence around the user's problem.

Figure 7 illustrates task-oriented content through E's error page. It starts with what the code can establish, identifies local information to collect, links observable symptoms to checks and attributed cases, and retains a support route for

EZ9999: organizing diagnostic guidance

Design illustration

Archived condition: a dedicated error page with generic diagnostic advice.

Starting point: the error code alone does not identify a specific cause.

Applies to: <version / component> Updated from: <source / date>

1 Identify the local information needed

Logs around the error, the triggering operation, components, and installed versions.

Explain which diagnostic distinction each item helps resolve.

2 Organize investigation around observable symptoms

Symptom / condition	Next check	Case and applicability evidence
<log pattern / trigger>	<check and expected observation>	<case link / version / source>

3 Retain unresolved branches and a support route

If the cause remains unresolved, identify missing evidence and carry the record into support.

Motivation: E; M3, M4. Proposed diagnostic structure with placeholder case fields.

Fig. 7. Proposed task-oriented diagnostic content, motivated by E's dedicated error page with generic guidance. The structure connects a diagnostic starting point, local information, checks, case evidence, and unresolved branches. Specific cases and version scopes remain fields to populate.

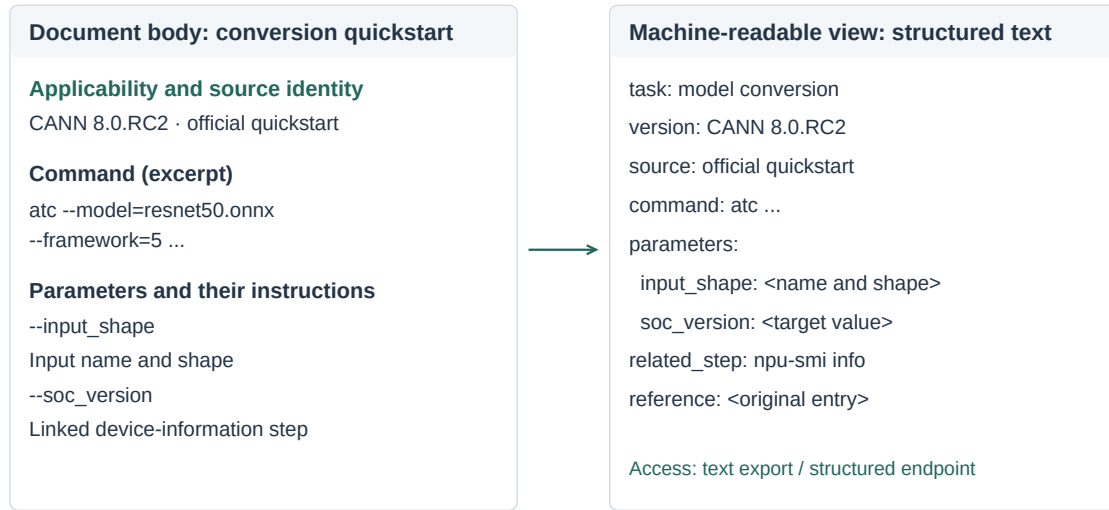
unresolved situations. Domain maintainers would need to establish the actual causes, checks, and cases; the structure helps locate the knowledge that needs to be supplied.

The same task-oriented structure can guide other documentation units. An intended outcome, prerequisites, minimal commands or code, parameter explanations, expected output, and recovery information provide concrete material for both human reading and agent retrieval. Machine-readable exports and indexes should preserve those relationships and their version scope. Their success can be checked against the relevant content-acquisition and detail fields for the task that motivated the change.

Figure 8 illustrates delivery of the same task material through a document body and a machine-readable export. Using A's retained command and parameter relations, the export preserves the task, applicable version, source, parameter explanations, and related steps. For a route such as D's, the aim is to deliver the missing core guidance; where a readable body already exists, the aim is to preserve its context during export. Acceptance checks should compare acquired content with task requirements, rather than only checking for a particular file format.

Third-party sources offer additional examples, explanations, and records of encountered failures. Their value depends on what an agent can actually obtain and attribute. Supporting accessible, versioned examples and accounts of issue resolution can extend the available knowledge beyond an official main path. M5 and M6 allow an audit to distinguish the number of encountered sources from their credibility and derivation. This is particularly useful when several posts repeat the same material or when a detailed explanation is visible in search but unavailable to the reading tool.

Two views of task material, preserving the same relationships



Proposed structure; command and parameters from A. Preserve body, version, and links; M2-M4.

Fig. 8. Proposed document body and machine-readable export. Command, parameter, and device-query relations come from A's retained material; the structured text is a proposed export. Both views preserve the task's version, source, and step relationships.

Knowledge provision also involves entry points and maintenance. Stable, searchable official entries affect whether candidate materials are discovered; explicit ownership, revision dates, and compatibility relations support subsequent assessment. Teams can use representative tasks as recurring inspection units, tracking whether queries reach the intended material, its body is delivered, version relations have changed, and community cases remain applicable. Such maintenance also addresses source governance and third-party knowledge provision beyond the illustrated interfaces.

7.2 Agent-side design: expose support and request missing task facts

An agent interface can preserve the difference between finding a relevant source, obtaining its body, and supporting a proposed step. For D, an informative status would identify the missing implementation guide. For E, it would indicate that the official explanation is generic and request the logs or trigger context needed for further diagnosis. For A, it could retain the usable conversion path while marking advanced reference settings as unresolved. These statuses connect a retrieval event to its consequence for the developer's current task.

Figure 9 contrasts interaction responses to these two gaps. When the body is unavailable, the interface retains the original guide entry so the developer can supply missing content. When acquired content lacks diagnostic detail, it requests trigger context and logs to support further investigation. The M1-M3 distinctions thus lead to different next actions; subsequent attempts and their acquisition effort can be recorded through M8.

Version-dependent guidance can similarly surface the environment facts on which a recommendation relies. Before proposing a specific toolkit/framework combination, the agent can request the current driver, package versions, or target device and associate the resulting recommendation with the relevant compatibility source. The response-level

Different knowledge gaps call for different next actions

(a) Body unavailable · based on task D

- 1 Relevant official guide found
- 2 Navigation and metadata returned
- 3 Core how-to body not obtained

Gap: the core implementation guide is missing

I found related material, but cannot verify the full procedure from this guide.

You can open the guide and add its content here so I can check the proposed steps.

[Open original guide](#)

(b) Content insufficient · based on task E

- 1 Official EZ9999 page found
- 2 Page body obtained
- 3 Only generic diagnostic advice supplied

Gap: the cause cannot yet be narrowed down

This page does not identify a specific cause. Please share the trigger and relevant logs.

I can use those details to find matching cases and suggest the next diagnostic check.

[Add context and logs](#)

Archived conditions: D / E. Proposed interface messages; M1-M3, with retry effort linked to M8.

Fig. 9. Proposed agent feedback for two knowledge gaps: (a) a missing core body, based on D; (b) readable but diagnostically insufficient content, based on E. The archive supplies the problem conditions; interface messages and next actions are design proposals.

indicators supply two checks for this interaction: whether the answer identifies its applicable version conditions and whether its steps are concrete enough to adopt with the stated substitutions or modifications.

Figure 10 illustrates version checking through a separate environment record. It distinguishes developer-supplied local facts from the applicability declared by a source, then records the comparison as matched, mismatched, or insufficient information. The record is reused within the task and updated with additional user input to support applicability checks before specific commands are recommended.

The three knowledge channels also suggest useful distinctions in how an agent presents support. A cited official procedure, a community workaround, and an explanation based on model prior knowledge have different provenance. Showing those differences can help a developer identify which part of a response warrants a local check. The retrieval loop can direct further searches toward a missing requirement and report remaining uncertainty when its budget is reached. This connects source inspection to collaboration through observable information needs and verification points.

Figure 11 further illustrates source inspection and corrective feedback. A developer can expand the cited passage for a command, inspect its applicable version, and attach an encountered error or correction to the suggestion. The original source, task environment, and new feedback remain connected so the next check can address the specific discrepancy. This provides inspectable support for the response properties described by M9 and M10 and for subsequent revision.

Task requirements can also guide retrieval routing and progress reporting. Questions about ecosystem-specific interfaces, errors, or compatibility combinations call for checks against sources tied to those requirements. Explanations based on general principles can identify which assumptions still need confirmation for the target environment. During a longer search, the interface can report the requirement being investigated, an encountered acquisition failure, and

Inspect the conversion guidance

Design illustration

Current task: model conversion

Keep the response, source passage, and feedback linked

View task

Conversion command in the response (excerpt)

atc --model=resnet50.onnx --framework=5 ...

Official quickstart · CANN 8.0.RC2

Expanded source passage

atc --model=resnet50.onnx --framework=5 --output=resnet50

--input_shape="actual_input_1:1,3,224,224" --soc_version=<soc_version>

Source entry: official model-conversion quickstart

Open the original page

Does this guidance differ from what you observed?

Attach an error or correction to this command, retaining its source and task context.

The next check uses both the original suggestion and the new feedback.

Add error or correction

Command excerpt retained from A; interface interaction is proposed. Linked to M4, M9, M10.

Fig. 11. Proposed source inspection and corrective feedback. The conversion-command excerpt is retained from A's quickstart material; source expansion, an original-page entry, and error feedback linked to the suggestion are proposed interactions.

web-framework assessment might inspect dependency combinations and deployment prerequisites. In each case, the evidence record specifies what supports a proposed action and which source or interaction condition needs attention.

Subsequent evaluation can examine whether independent analysts produce comparable profiles, whether the diagnoses correspond to expert assessments of missing information, and whether documentation teams find them useful for planning repairs. These questions follow directly from the intended use of the method. The present application supplies the task-level distinctions, worked records, and cross-task synthesis on which such evaluation can build.

8 LIMITATIONS AND RESEARCH TRANSPARENCY

The case demonstrates how the method distinguishes breakdowns in discovery, content acquisition, and task adequacy. The retained records support inspection of coding decisions and reproduction of score calculations. Some model and tool settings could not be recovered from the available materials, leaving stability across configurations unassessed. Independent coding agreement and applicability across ecosystems require further evaluation. The supplement provides frozen observation fields, the original scoring implementation, task and provenance tables, discrepancy notes, and scripts for the archival summaries so that subsequent work can evaluate the method under stated configurations and independent coding conditions.

9 CONCLUSION

We define knowledge availability for AI and operationalize it through eleven indicators connecting knowledge sources, acquisition processes, and response properties. The accelerator-development application shows how this multidimensional view identifies distinct acquisition and content failures, recurring version issues, and task-dependent configurations of knowledge support. Contrasting tasks motivate attention to ecosystem-specific knowledge requirements alongside workflow coverage.

These diagnoses connect measurement to design. Shared version and compatibility capabilities address recurring conditions, while readable task guides and concrete diagnostic content address localized breakdowns. Agent interfaces can expose the corresponding support, request missing environment facts, and organize the next verification step. The contribution is a reusable way to move from recorded task evidence to a specific diagnosis and an appropriate design response, supported by an inspectable protocol and case materials.

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